

Time to Think Baseball

With basketball's roaring climax now in the record books, a sharp and woody cracking noise is coming in clearly from the direction of Hollywood, Fla.

There another new edition of the Indianapolis Indians baseball club is in the opening stages of a 19-game exhibition schedule. The Tribe gave up five unearned runs and had 14 runners stranded on base in losing the opener to the Buffalo Internationals.

This, of course, doesn't sound like the Indian club of last year which, under Manager Kerby Farrell, won the American Association pennant and then the Little World Series. On the other hand, there is the admonition of Les Koelling, The News baseball pundit, to the effect that "if the early results are somewhat shocking, they needn't be accepted too seriously."

In the first place, the 1957 Indians had only one player from last year available in action against the Bisons. The club this year has a new manager, up and coming Andy Cohen. And a new affiliation, with the Chicago White Sox.

Indianapolis fans perhaps need to be reminded that the Indians also were a raw young team in spring training last year, a team which lost a bunch of games not only in Florida, but in the Association race before it began to hit championship form.

This crop of 1957 youngsters will bear watching. The White Sox already have sent over a couple of promising batters to boost the Indian offensive power. We'll soon see what we'll see. It's a great game, and we're proud again for a second year that Indianapolis has a community-owned baseball team.

At Last, the Korean Bonus

Not only the Korean War veterans who will receive the \$200 checks, but all the rest of the state's population will be glad to know that payment will start soon.

There has been too long a delay about this matter. No single individual or agency of government has been to blame. The fault was in a confusing wording in the 1955 bonus law.

The last session of the Legislature,

in enacting another bonus payment law to clarify the 1955 law, nearly pulled the same blooper. However, plans to begin payments are proceeding, even though the new law has some confused wording, too.

Veterans receiving the \$200 will find that it won't last long in today's high living costs. Yet it is a token of the deep gratitude felt by the state for their sacrifices.